

Flickr is *one more addiction* for thousands of photographers all over the world. The name *flickr* is significant in more ways than one (a) in the sense of *flick* (a movie), (b) the *flickering* of the screen or (c) flicking through the pages of your photo album – but none of these may have been the logic behind the choice of this interestingly misspelt name.



Flick through your pics with Flickr

In March 2005, Yahoo! took over Ludicorp, acquiring Flickr in the process, and this has only been icing on the cake. Some of the features that make Flickr exciting are:

Tags:

Flickr allows you to *tag* photos. Tagging is using a form of ‘metadata’ – structured data attached to other data, making locating and organising much easier. This is also similar to the cataloguing that you’re used to seeing in libraries. You can add either single or multiple tags to the photos you upload. Tags serve as reference terms, simplifying search for particular kinds of photographs. This kind of collaborative creation of metadata is what netizens know as ‘folksonomy’ – and though Flickr didn’t really start it, it sure was a part of the leading pack.